

Chapter 8 — Akṣara-Brahma Yoga

అక్షరబ్రహ్మయోగః : అక్షరబ్రహ్మయోగము

"The Yoga of the Imperishable Brahman" · 28 verses · What happens at death

Chapter 8 takes up the question that haunts every conscious being: *"What happens at death?"* Kṛṣṇa's answer is luminous and practical: **the state of consciousness at the moment of dying determines the next destination**. Therefore the entire life must be a long preparation — a continual remembering of the Divine. This chapter introduces the sacred syllable **Om** as the consciousness-bridge across the threshold of death.

Essential verses of Chapter 8

BG 8.5 *Whoever remembers Me at the end attains My nature*

अन्तकाले च मामेव स्मरन्मुक्त्वा कलेवरम् ।

यः प्रयाति स मद्भावं याति नास्त्यत्र संशयः ॥ ८.५ ॥

అంతకాలే చ మమేవ స్మరన్ముక్త్వా కలేవరమ్ ।

యః ప్రయాతి స మద్భావం యాతి నాస్త్యత్ర సంశయః ॥ ౮.౫ ॥

anta-kāle ca mām eva smaran muktvā kalevaram |

yaḥ prayāti sa mad-bhāvaṁ yāti nāsty atra saṁśayaḥ ||

"Whoever, at the time of death, departs the body remembering Me alone — he attains My nature. Of this there is no doubt."

BG 8.6 *Whatever you remember at the end — that you become*

यं यं वापि स्मरन्भावं त्यजत्यन्ते कलेवरम् ।

तं तमेवैति कौन्तेय सदा तद्भावभाविनः ॥ ८.६ ॥

యం యం వాపి స్మరన్భావం త్యజత్యన్తే కలేవరమ్ ।

తం తమేవైతి కౌన్తేయ సదా తద్భావభావితః ॥ ౮.౬ ॥

yaṁ yaṁ vāpi smaran bhāvaṁ tyajaty ante kalevaram |

taṁ tam evaiti kaunteya sadā tad-bhāva-bhāvitah ||

"Whatever state of being one remembers when leaving the body at the end — that very state one attains, O Kaunteya, being always absorbed in that state."

The crucial verse: *the last thought matters because it is the harvest of all previous thoughts*.

Word-by-Word — 8.6 (what you remember at the end, you become)

IAST	संस्कृत	प्रसृत	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>yaṁ yaṁ</i>	यं यम्	యం యమ్	yam yam	whatever (state)
<i>vā api</i>	वा अपि	వా అపి	vaa A-pi	or even
<i>smaran</i>	स्मरन्	స్మరన్	SMA-ran	remembering
<i>bhāvam</i>	भावम्	భావమ్	BHAA-vam	state of being / feeling
<i>tyajati</i>	त्यजति	త్యజతి	TYA-ja-ti	leaves, gives up
<i>ante</i>	अन्ते	అంతే	AN-te	at the end
<i>kalevaram</i>	कलेवरम्	కలేవరమ్	ka-LE-va-ram	the body
<i>taṁ tam eva eti</i>	तं तम् एव एति	తం తమ్ ఏవ ఏతి	tam tam E-va E-ti	that very (state) one attains

IAST	कौन्तेय	कौन्तेय	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>kaunteya</i>	कौन्तेय	कौन्तेय	kaun-TE-ya	O Kaunteya (Arjuna)
<i>sadā</i>	सदा	సదా	sa-DAA	always
<i>tad-bhāva-bhāvitaḥ</i>	तद्भावभावितः	తద్భావభావితః	tad-BHAA-va-BHAA-vi-tah	absorbed in / contemplating that state

BG 8.7 *Therefore: remember Me always — and act*

तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु मामनुस्मर युध्य च ।

मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्मामेवैष्यस्यसंशयम् ॥ ८.७ ॥

తస్మాత్సర్వేషు కాలేషు మామనుస్మర యుద్య చ ।

మయ్యర్పితమనోబుద్ధిర్మమేవైష్యస్యసంశయమ్ ॥ ౮.౭ ॥

tasmāt sarveṣu kāleṣu mām anusmara yudhya ca |

mayy arpita-mano-buddhir mām evaiṣyasy asaṁśayam ||

"Therefore, at all times remember Me — and fight.

With mind and intellect dedicated to Me,
you shall come to Me alone — without doubt."

The Gītā's most pragmatic counsel: *integrate worship into life, not life into worship.*

□ Essential take-away of Chapter 8

Your last thought is your harvest — so plant accordingly every day.

Death is not a separate event from life; it is the **final exam of your daily attention**. Whatever you have given your mind to throughout life will spontaneously arise at the end.

The practice: at all times (*sarveṣu kāleṣu*), in every state of life, keep remembering the Divine — "*and fight*" means: **do not retreat from life**. Action and remembrance go together.